

Tony sold the partnership in his physiotherapy practice in 2018. When I talked to Tony about different ways he could earn income now that he'd sold it, he ultimately reverted back to working as a physiotherapist, in a reaction typical of his Worker Money Type. If he's honest, he can't really imagine earning income another way than through his own personal exertion. He defaults to what he feels confident and comfortable doing, which still brings him in the income he wants.

Aside from his ability to work, one of Tony's strength is that he's not a spender. He recognises the hours that he puts in and how hard he works for that money. He also likes the safety of a large cash buffer and doesn't want to see it diminish with what he perceives as reckless spending. However, because he's busy and doesn't like lists or planning, he'll regularly and inadvertently buy multiple items that he already has. In this way, he has the capacity to be unconsciously neglectful or wasteful with some of his spending.

Now, just like people don't operate in isolation, different Money Types will also interact when they're in a relationship, which is why it's important to understand your partner's Money Type (and Money Story). Because I want you to start sharing stories and experiences and understanding how others interact financially, I'll share my interaction with Tony here. In my case, I'm a Discerner (we look at Discerners later in this chapter) with a small dash of Worker Money Type. In the past, I have been frustrated and surprised by Tony's seeming unwillingness to do anything other than primarily earn his income through working long hours.

To change his behaviour, I've tried telling him what my hourly rate is, I've tried taking him to talks by experts who will expose him to different strategies, I've tried giving him ideas as to how he could earn income in different ways. Tony is possibly one of the smartest people I know and theoretically understands these different strategies, but has said he knows he won't do anything about them because he can earn a good income through his personal exertion. In his words, he 'can't be bothered doing anything else'. Eventually, I've had to make the decision to let him earn money the way that's most comfortable for him.

However, because I know his natural inclination is personal exertion, I don't leave our investing decisions to him. Instead, I manage our family investing and I keep him regularly updated so that he knows what's going on with our money and feels comfortable, but doesn't have to worry about the details. The level of checking-in depends on the size of the investment. With a